

of a larger idea they were working under – the MC Link which was a short-range communication link between the phone and the communications device.

The technology was new, moreover it was cheap since it was tapping into a low-frequency radio band that required no licensing, meaning that everyone in the world could use it. However, what they realised was that if they did want Bluetooth to be a universal communication medium that every person could use to interface with surrounding electronic devices, other manufacturers of equipment would have to adhere to similar standards. Hence, in 1997, Ericsson decided to give away its technology for free. Bluetooth was no longer its property.

The name has an interesting origin, as does the logo. The technology, since it was pioneered in Scandinavia, was named after King Harald Bluetooth of Denmark, who united warring Danish tribes into a single kingdom. Marketing Bluetooth as a standard communication protocol that everyone could adhere to and follow was a good decision. The Bluetooth logo is a bind rune merging the Germanic runes H (Hagall) and B (Berkanan) for Harold Bluetooth.

The Bluetooth SIG (special interest group): the Bluetooth SIG is a group of companies which take care to maintain the standards and licensing agreements involved with Bluetooth. The special interest group has companies participating from different industries, all of whom think that

Bluetooth will make a difference to the way they do business.

After 1997, Ericsson began talking to different companies, insistent on creating a new global standard for communication. They sought to bring together market leaders in mobile telephony, portable computing, digital signal processing, everyone who could help make Bluetooth the household phenomenon it is today. In 1998, it tied up with Nokia, IBM, Toshiba and Intel. They held simultaneous press conferences to announce that they were developing a licence-free, open specification for wireless communication, and the idea took off. The Bluetooth SIG is responsible for maintaining the



Bluetooth Logo